repeated officially, is that Gandhiji and the Congress have agreed to the idea of such safeguards because 'safeguards in the interests of India' were accepted in the Delhi Pact of 1931.

Ottawa and the safeguards dealing with trade and commerce are after all relatively minor matters.[1] What is far more important is the series of provisions which aim at perpetuating every vital political and economic hold on the Indian people which has in the past and present helped in the exploitation of the country. So long as these provisions and 'safeguards' remain, real progress in any direction is impossible, and there is no place left for constitutional attempts at change. Every such attempt will come up against the blank wall of the 'safeguards', and make it more and more clear that the only possible course is not constitutional. From the point of view of political changes this proposed constitution, with its monstrous Federation, is an absurdity; it is far worse from the social and economic view-point. The way to socialism is deliberately barred. A great deal of responsibility has apparently been transferred (but even that largely to 'safe' classes) but not the power or means to do anything worth while. Britain retains the power without the responsibility. There is not even the proverbial fig-leaf to cover the nakedness of autocracy. Everybody knows that the essential need in these times is extreme flexibility and adaptation in constitutions to meet a rapidly changing situation. Quick decisions are necessary, and the power to enforce them. Even so it is doubtful if parliamentary democracy, as it functions in a few of the Western countries to-day, is capable of bringing about the changes essential for the proper functioning of the modern world. But that question does not arise here, for movement is deliberately checked by chains and fetters, and a barred and bolted door confronts us. We are provided with a car, all brakes and no engines. It is a constitution designed by people whose ever-present background is Martial Law. To a man of force there is no real alternative to Martial Law except collapse.

The measure of liberty that this proposed gift of Britain offers to India can be taken from the fact that even the most moderate and politically backward groups in India have

[1] The London *Economist* (October 1934) has pointed out: "But for the future it appears that among the benefits of British rule the doubtful privilege of buying expensively from Lancashire is to be forced upon the 'native' in many corners of the globe." Ceylon has been the most flagrant recent example of this.